



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 1-8 | No doses

Paracetamol

1

CLASS: Analgesic / antipyretic

USES: Mild to moderate pain; fever

WATCH: Liver injury, especially with overdose or duplicate products

Ibuprofen

2

CLASS: NSAID

USES: Pain, fever and inflammation

WATCH: Gastrointestinal bleeding; kidney injury; fluid retention

Aspirin

3

CLASS: Antiplatelet / NSAID

USES: Selected cardiovascular prevention; pain and inflammation

WATCH: Bleeding; gastric irritation; bronchospasm in susceptible people

Naproxen

4

CLASS: NSAID

USES: Musculoskeletal pain and inflammatory arthritis

WATCH: Gastrointestinal bleeding; kidney injury; fluid retention

Morphine

5

CLASS: Opioid analgesic

USES: Severe pain

WATCH: Respiratory depression; sedation; constipation; dependence

Fentanyl

6

CLASS: Opioid analgesic

USES: Severe pain; anaesthesia adjunct

WATCH: Respiratory depression; sedation; dependence

Lidocaine (lignocaine)

7

CLASS: Local anaesthetic / antiarrhythmic

USES: Local anaesthesia; selected ventricular arrhythmias

WATCH: Systemic toxicity: seizures, arrhythmias and cardiac arrest

Propofol

8

CLASS: Intravenous anaesthetic

USES: Anaesthesia and monitored sedation

WATCH: Respiratory depression; hypotension; rare infusion syndrome



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 9–16 | No doses

Ketamine

9

CLASS: NMDA antagonist / anaesthetic
USES: Anaesthesia, procedural sedation and selected pain care
WATCH: Raised blood pressure; emergence reactions; airway complications

Ondansetron

10

CLASS: Serotonin antagonist antiemetic
USES: Prevention and treatment of selected nausea and vomiting
WATCH: Headache; constipation; QT prolongation

Metoclopramide

11

CLASS: Dopamine antagonist / prokinetic
USES: Short-term nausea and vomiting; selected gastric stasis
WATCH: Dystonia and other movement disorders; drowsiness

Omeprazole

12

CLASS: Proton pump inhibitor
USES: Reflux; peptic ulcers; part of H. pylori treatment
WATCH: Headache; diarrhoea; low magnesium with prolonged use

Famotidine

13

CLASS: Histamine H₂ receptor antagonist
USES: Reflux and peptic ulcers
WATCH: Headache; bowel changes; confusion, especially in older adults

Loperamide

14

CLASS: Antidiarrhoeal
USES: Symptom relief in selected diarrhoeal illness
WATCH: Constipation; ileus; serious cardiac toxicity with misuse

Macrogol

15

CLASS: Osmotic laxative
USES: Constipation; some products for faecal impaction
WATCH: Bloating; diarrhoea; electrolyte disturbance

Amoxicillin

16

CLASS: Penicillin antibiotic
USES: Susceptible bacterial infections
WATCH: Allergy, including anaphylaxis; diarrhoea; rash



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 17-24 | No doses

Ampicillin

17

CLASS: Penicillin antibiotic

USES: Selected susceptible infections, including *Listeria*

WATCH: Allergy, including anaphylaxis; diarrhoea; rash

Benzylpenicillin

18

CLASS: Penicillin antibiotic

USES: Selected susceptible bacterial infections

WATCH: Allergy, including anaphylaxis; neurotoxicity with accumulation

Cefalexin

19

CLASS: First-generation cephalosporin

USES: Selected skin and urinary tract infections

WATCH: Allergy; diarrhoea; *C. difficile* infection

Ceftriaxone

20

CLASS: Third-generation cephalosporin

USES: Selected serious infections; meningitis; gonorrhoea

WATCH: Allergy; diarrhoea; biliary sludge

Cefepime

21

CLASS: Fourth-generation cephalosporin

USES: Selected severe infections, including *Pseudomonas*

WATCH: Neurotoxicity, especially with kidney impairment; allergy

Piperacillin / tazobactam

22

CLASS: Penicillin / beta-lactamase inhibitor

USES: Selected severe or mixed bacterial infections

WATCH: Allergy; diarrhoea; blood-count changes; kidney injury

Vancomycin

23

CLASS: Glycopeptide antibiotic

USES: Serious Gram-positive infection; oral use for *C. difficile*

WATCH: Kidney injury; infusion-related reaction; blood-count changes

Azithromycin

24

CLASS: Macrolide antibiotic

USES: Selected respiratory and other susceptible infections

WATCH: Gastrointestinal upset; QT prolongation; liver injury



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 25–32 | No doses

Clindamycin

25

CLASS: Lincosamide antibiotic

USES: Selected skin, bone and anaerobic infections

WATCH: Diarrhoea; *C. difficile* colitis; rash

Doxycycline

26

CLASS: Tetracycline antibiotic

USES: Acne; selected respiratory and tick-borne infections

WATCH: Photosensitivity; oesophagitis; gastrointestinal upset

Ciprofloxacin

27

CLASS: Fluoroquinolone antibiotic

USES: Selected susceptible infections when appropriate

WATCH: Tendon injury; neuropathy; psychiatric effects; QT prolongation

Levofloxacin*

28

CLASS: Fluoroquinolone antibiotic

USES: Specialist use, including selected tuberculosis regimens

WATCH: Tendon injury; neuropathy; psychiatric effects; QT prolongation

Metronidazole

29

CLASS: Nitroimidazole antimicrobial

USES: Anaerobic bacterial and selected protozoal infections

WATCH: Nausea; metallic taste; peripheral neuropathy

Trimethoprim / sulfamethoxazole

30

CLASS: Combination antibacterial

USES: Selected urinary infections; *Pneumocystis* treatment/prevention

WATCH: Rash, including severe skin reactions; hyperkalaemia; cytopenias

Nitrofurantoin

31

CLASS: Nitrofuran urinary antibiotic

USES: Selected lower urinary tract infections

WATCH: Nausea; lung or liver toxicity; peripheral neuropathy

Meropenem

32

CLASS: Carbapenem antibiotic

USES: Selected severe or resistant bacterial infections

WATCH: Allergy; diarrhoea; seizures



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 33–40 | No doses

Fluconazole

33

CLASS: Triazole antifungal

USES: Selected Candida and other susceptible fungal infections

WATCH: Liver injury; QT prolongation; important drug interactions

Aciclovir

34

CLASS: Antiviral

USES: Herpes simplex and varicella-zoster infections

WATCH: Kidney injury; neurotoxicity, especially with accumulation

Oseltamivir

35

CLASS: Neuraminidase inhibitor

USES: Influenza treatment; selected exposure prevention

WATCH: Nausea; vomiting; rare serious skin or behavioural reactions

Atorvastatin

36

CLASS: Statin

USES: Lipid lowering and cardiovascular risk reduction

WATCH: Muscle symptoms; rare rhabdomyolysis; liver enzyme elevation

Ezetimibe

37

CLASS: Cholesterol absorption inhibitor

USES: Cholesterol lowering, often with a statin

WATCH: Gastrointestinal upset; muscle symptoms; liver enzyme elevation

Heparin (unfractionated)

38

CLASS: Anticoagulant

USES: Prevention/treatment of thrombosis; selected acute coronary care

WATCH: Bleeding; heparin-induced thrombocytopenia

Warfarin

39

CLASS: Vitamin K antagonist anticoagulant

USES: Prevention and treatment of thromboembolism

WATCH: Bleeding; many interactions; fetal harm; rare skin necrosis

Apixaban

40

CLASS: Direct factor Xa inhibitor

USES: Selected AF stroke prevention; DVT/PE treatment/prevention

WATCH: Bleeding; important drug interactions



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 41-48 | No doses

Clopidogrel

41

CLASS: P2Y12 inhibitor antiplatelet

USES: Selected coronary, stroke and peripheral arterial care

WATCH: Bleeding; bruising; rare serious blood disorders

Glyceryl trinitrate

42

CLASS: Nitrate vasodilator

USES: Angina; selected acute coronary and cardiac care

WATCH: Headache; hypotension; dangerous interaction with PDE5 inhibitors

Amlodipine

43

CLASS: Calcium channel blocker

USES: Hypertension and angina

WATCH: Ankle swelling; flushing; headache; hypotension

Diltiazem

44

CLASS: Non-dihydropyridine calcium blocker

USES: Angina; hypertension; selected heart-rate control

WATCH: Bradycardia; heart block; hypotension; worsening heart failure

Metoprolol

45

CLASS: Beta1-selective blocker

USES: Hypertension; angina; selected arrhythmia and heart failure care

WATCH: Bradycardia; hypotension; fatigue; bronchospasm

Propranolol

46

CLASS: Non-selective beta blocker

USES: Selected tremor, migraine prevention and cardiovascular care

WATCH: Bradycardia; hypotension; bronchospasm; masked hypoglycaemia

Lisinopril

47

CLASS: ACE inhibitor

USES: Hypertension; selected heart failure and post-infarct care

WATCH: Cough; hyperkalaemia; kidney impairment; angioedema; fetal harm

Losartan

48

CLASS: Angiotensin II receptor blocker

USES: Hypertension; selected diabetic kidney disease

WATCH: Hyperkalaemia; hypotension; kidney impairment; fetal harm



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 49–56 | No doses

Hydrochlorothiazide

49

CLASS: Thiazide diuretic

USES: Hypertension and selected oedema

WATCH: Low sodium/potassium; dehydration; raised urate

Furosemide

50

CLASS: Loop diuretic

USES: Fluid overload, including heart failure

WATCH: Dehydration; low potassium/sodium; hypotension; ototoxicity

Spironolactone

51

CLASS: Aldosterone antagonist

USES: Heart failure; oedema; excess aldosterone

WATCH: High potassium; breast enlargement; kidney impairment

Digoxin

52

CLASS: Cardiac glycoside

USES: Selected heart failure; AF rate control

WATCH: Toxicity: nausea, visual changes, arrhythmias

Amiodarone

53

CLASS: Antiarrhythmic

USES: Selected atrial and ventricular arrhythmias

WATCH: Lung, thyroid and liver toxicity; slow heart rate

Adenosine

54

CLASS: Antiarrhythmic

USES: Selected regular supraventricular tachycardia

WATCH: Flushing; chest discomfort; brief heart block; bronchospasm

Atropine

55

CLASS: Antimuscarinic

USES: Symptomatic bradycardia; selected poisonings

WATCH: Fast heart rate; dry mouth; urinary retention; confusion

Adrenaline

56

CLASS: Adrenergic agonist

USES: Anaphylaxis; cardiac arrest (different protocols)

WATCH: Tachycardia; hypertension; arrhythmias; tissue injury



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 57–64 | No doses

Noradrenaline

57

CLASS: Vasopressor

USES: Severe hypotension, including septic shock

WATCH: Poor peripheral perfusion; arrhythmias; extravasation injury

Dobutamine

58

CLASS: Inotrope

USES: Selected low-output states; cardiogenic shock

WATCH: Tachycardia; arrhythmias; blood pressure changes

Dopamine

59

CLASS: Catecholamine inotrope

USES: Selected circulatory support in monitored settings

WATCH: Arrhythmias; ischaemia; extravasation injury

Alteplase

60

CLASS: Thrombolytic

USES: Selected ischaemic stroke, pulmonary embolism or STEMI

WATCH: Major bleeding, including intracranial haemorrhage

Insulin

61

CLASS: Glucose-lowering hormone

USES: Diabetes; DKA requires a specific hospital protocol

WATCH: Hypoglycaemia; low potassium; product mix-ups

Metformin

62

CLASS: Biguanide

USES: Type 2 diabetes

WATCH: Gastrointestinal upset; low vitamin B12; rare lactic acidosis

Glipizide

63

CLASS: Sulfonylurea

USES: Type 2 diabetes

WATCH: Hypoglycaemia; weight gain

Empagliflozin

64

CLASS: SGLT2 inhibitor

USES: Type 2 diabetes; heart failure; chronic kidney disease

WATCH: Genital infection; dehydration; ketoacidosis despite modest glucose



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 65–72 | No doses

Semaglutide

65

CLASS: GLP-1 receptor agonist
 USES: Type 2 diabetes or weight management: product-specific
 WATCH: Nausea; vomiting; dehydration; pancreatitis; gallbladder disease

Levothyroxine (thyroxine)

66

CLASS: Thyroid hormone
 USES: Hypothyroidism
 WATCH: Excess replacement: palpitations, tremor, arrhythmias

Thiamazole (methimazole)

67

CLASS: Antithyroid; see Australian note
 USES: Hyperthyroidism; not a routine Australian product
 WATCH: Low white cells; liver injury; pregnancy risks

Hydrocortisone

68

CLASS: Corticosteroid
 USES: Adrenal hormone replacement; selected inflammation
 WATCH: High glucose; infection; adrenal suppression with ongoing use

Dexamethasone

69

CLASS: Corticosteroid
 USES: Selected inflammation; cerebral oedema
 WATCH: High glucose; infection; mood changes; adrenal suppression

Prednisone

70

CLASS: Corticosteroid
 USES: Inflammatory and autoimmune conditions
 WATCH: High glucose; infection; osteoporosis; adrenal suppression

Salbutamol

71

CLASS: Short-acting beta2 agonist
 USES: Relief of bronchospasm
 WATCH: Tremor; fast heart rate; low potassium with intensive use

Ipratropium

72

CLASS: Inhaled antimuscarinic
 USES: COPD; adjunct in selected asthma exacerbations
 WATCH: Dry mouth; urinary retention; avoid spray entering eyes



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 73–80 | No doses

Budesonide

73

CLASS: Corticosteroid

USES: Inhaled asthma prevention; other uses vary by formulation

WATCH: Inhaled: oral thrush; hoarse voice; rinse mouth afterwards

Montelukast

74

CLASS: Leukotriene receptor antagonist

USES: Asthma prevention; selected allergic rhinitis

WATCH: Serious mood, behaviour and sleep changes; suicidal thoughts

Diphenhydramine

75

CLASS: Sedating antihistamine

USES: Selected allergy symptoms; uses vary by product

WATCH: Sedation; dry mouth; urinary retention; confusion

Cetirizine

76

CLASS: Antihistamine

USES: Allergic rhinitis; urticaria

WATCH: Drowsiness; dry mouth

Naloxone

77

CLASS: Opioid antagonist

USES: Reversal of opioid-induced respiratory depression

WATCH: Acute withdrawal; opioid effects may return as it wears off

Flumazenil

78

CLASS: Benzodiazepine antagonist

USES: Selected benzodiazepine reversal in monitored settings

WATCH: Seizures; withdrawal; resedation; not routine in mixed overdose

Acetylcysteine

79

CLASS: Antidote; glutathione precursor

USES: Paracetamol poisoning under a treatment protocol

WATCH: Nausea; vomiting; infusion-related hypersensitivity

Calcium gluconate

80

CLASS: Calcium salt

USES: Hypocalcaemia; cardiac protection in severe hyperkalaemia

WATCH: Extravasation injury; hypercalcaemia; arrhythmias



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 81-88 | No doses

Diazepam

81

CLASS: Benzodiazepine

USES: Selected anxiety, seizures and muscle spasm

WATCH: Sedation; respiratory depression; dependence; withdrawal

Lorazepam

82

CLASS: Benzodiazepine

USES: Anxiety; other uses depend on formulation and protocol

WATCH: Sedation; respiratory depression; dependence; withdrawal

Midazolam

83

CLASS: Benzodiazepine

USES: Procedural sedation; seizure management

WATCH: Respiratory depression; sedation; hypotension

Sertraline

84

CLASS: SSRI antidepressant

USES: Depression; OCD; selected anxiety disorders

WATCH: Gastrointestinal upset; sexual dysfunction; serotonin syndrome

Fluoxetine

85

CLASS: SSRI antidepressant

USES: Depression; OCD; bulimia nervosa

WATCH: Insomnia; sexual dysfunction; serotonin syndrome

Escitalopram

86

CLASS: SSRI antidepressant

USES: Depression; selected anxiety disorders

WATCH: Nausea; sexual dysfunction; QT prolongation; serotonin syndrome

Venlafaxine

87

CLASS: SNRI antidepressant

USES: Depression; selected anxiety disorders

WATCH: Raised blood pressure; withdrawal symptoms; serotonin syndrome

Amitriptyline

88

CLASS: Tricyclic antidepressant

USES: Depression; neuropathic pain (off-label)

WATCH: Sedation; anticholinergic effects; arrhythmias; overdose toxicity



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 89–96 | No doses

Bupropion

89

CLASS: Reuptake inhibitor (NDRI)

USES: Smoking cessation alongside support (Zyban SR)

WATCH: Seizures; insomnia; raised blood pressure

Lithium

90

CLASS: Mood stabiliser

USES: Bipolar disorder; specialist mood-disorder treatment

WATCH: Toxicity; tremor; kidney and thyroid effects; interactions

Sodium valproate

91

CLASS: Antiseizure medicine; mood stabiliser

USES: Epilepsy; selected bipolar disorder treatment

WATCH: Liver injury; pancreatitis; major pregnancy-related harm

Carbamazepine

92

CLASS: Antiseizure medicine

USES: Epilepsy; trigeminal neuralgia; selected bipolar disorder

WATCH: Low sodium; serious rash; blood disorders; interactions

Levetiracetam

93

CLASS: Antiseizure medicine

USES: Epilepsy

WATCH: Sleepiness; irritability; mood and behaviour changes

Phenytoin

94

CLASS: Antiseizure medicine

USES: Selected seizure disorders

WATCH: Ataxia; gum overgrowth; serious rash; interactions; toxicity

Haloperidol

95

CLASS: First-generation antipsychotic

USES: Psychosis; selected severe agitation

WATCH: Movement disorders; QT prolongation; neuroleptic malignant syndrome

Risperidone

96

CLASS: Second-generation antipsychotic

USES: Schizophrenia; selected bipolar mania

WATCH: Raised prolactin; movement disorders; metabolic effects



MEET THE MEDICINES

Australian names | Cards 97–100 | No doses

Quetiapine

97

CLASS: Second-generation antipsychotic
 USES: Schizophrenia; bipolar disorder; selected MDD (XR)
 WATCH: Sedation; postural hypotension; metabolic effects

Levodopa/carbidopa

98

CLASS: Dopamine precursor + enzyme inhibitor
 USES: Parkinson disease
 WATCH: Dyskinesia; hallucinations; postural hypotension

Alendronate

99

CLASS: Bisphosphonate
 USES: Osteoporosis; selected other bone conditions
 WATCH: Oesophageal irritation; rare jaw osteonecrosis and atypical fractures

Allopurinol

100

CLASS: Xanthine oxidase inhibitor
 USES: Long-term urate lowering in gout; selected hyperuricaemia
 WATCH: Rash; rare severe hypersensitivity; important interactions

QUICK WORD CHECK

AF: atrial fibrillation. DVT: deep vein thrombosis. PE: pulmonary embolism. DKA: diabetic ketoacidosis. COPD: chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. OCD: obsessive-compulsive disorder. MDD: major depressive disorder. XR: extended release. STEMI: ST-elevation myocardial infarction. NSAID: non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drug. SSRI/SNRI: serotonin / serotonin-noradrenaline reuptake inhibitors. QT prolongation: delayed electrical recovery of the heart, which can increase arrhythmia risk.

* Levofloxacin: retained from the source list for specialist learning; not presented as a routine Australian first-choice antibiotic.



READ ME FIRST

Australian context | How to use this study guide

A memory aid, not a medication order

These cards summarise medicine classes, selected uses and important adverse effects. They do not list every risk, interaction, contraindication or monitoring requirement. No doses are included.

Check before every administration

Use the medication order, local policy and current Australian medicine information. Check allergies, indication, formulation, route, relevant observations and pathology. Ask your supervising nurse, pharmacist or prescriber when unsure.

Names you will see in Australia

Paracetamol, salbutamol, adrenaline, noradrenaline, glyceryl trinitrate, benzylpenicillin, cefalexin and aciclovir replace overseas names or spellings. Some labels still show familiar alternative names.

Overseas medicines are flagged

The original list is retained for learning continuity. Thiamazole (methimazole) and levofloxacin need Australian availability and specialist-context checks. Carbimazole is a different medicine, not a direct name substitution.

High-risk medicines need extra care

Anticoagulants, insulin, opioids, sedatives and concentrated electrolytes require particular care. Use local monitoring and independent-check requirements. A short WATCH line is not a complete safety checklist.

Educational review

Prepared 3 October 2026 using Australian public medicine information and safety guidance. Independent AI content and layout checks were completed; this is not pharmacist certification. Obtain local clinical review before institutional use.



REFERENCE DESK

Click a source to check current information

Australian medicine product information

Australian Commission on Safety and Quality in Health Care – Medicine Finder [OPEN SOURCE]

Australian medicines and ingredient names

Healthdirect Australia – medicines directory [OPEN SOURCE]

Australian registration and availability

Therapeutic Goods Administration – Australian Register of Therapeutic Goods [OPEN SOURCE]

Australian ingredient naming

Therapeutic Goods Administration – updated ingredient names [OPEN SOURCE]

Bupropion: Australian approved use and precautions

Zyban SR – Australian product information [OPEN SOURCE]

Anticoagulant indication and safety information

Eliquis – Australian product information [OPEN SOURCE]

SGLT2 inhibitors and ketoacidosis

Therapeutic Goods Administration – safety alert [OPEN SOURCE]

Antiepileptic medicines and pregnancy risks

Therapeutic Goods Administration – updated precautions [OPEN SOURCE]

Acute coronary syndromes

Heart Foundation – Australian clinical guideline 2025 [OPEN SOURCE]

Resuscitation medicine context

ANZCOR – adult advanced life support guidelines [OPEN SOURCE]

Fluoroquinolone safety warnings

Therapeutic Goods Administration – serious adverse effects [OPEN SOURCE]

Montelukast neuropsychiatric warnings

Therapeutic Goods Administration – safety update [OPEN SOURCE]

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